

YUFENG (FELIX) XU

Email · Homepage · LinkedIn · GitHub · New York, NY

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am currently working on algorithm-system co-design for efficient training and inference of language models, spanning both standard text generation and search agents. I am also interested in new paradigms for language models, such as diffusion language models and Engram-style conditional memory.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science Sep 2026 - Present

New York University | New York, NY

- Advisor: Prof. Yucheng Lu

B.S. in Computer Science (with highest honors) Sep 2022 - Jun 2026

New York University Shanghai | Shanghai, China

- Cumulative GPA: 3.99/4.0

PUBLICATIONS

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| NeurIPS 2026 | • Y. Xu , Z. Bao, Q. Wang, Z. Zhang, H. Zhang, B. Peng, A. Li, R. Chalamala, Y. Lu. <i>Multi-Token Residual Prediction</i> . [arXiv] |
| ICML 2026 | • D. Zhang, Y. Xu , H. Wang, Q. Chen, H. Peng. <i>Good SFT Optimizes for SFT, Better SFT Prepares for Reinforcement Learning</i> . [arXiv] |
| Under Review | • Y. Xu , T. Lu, J. Zhu, M. Sun, K. Li, Z. Liu. <i>Small LLMs: Pruning vs Training from Scratch</i> . [arXiv] |

TEACHING

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| Spring 2026 | • Lead Learning Assistant, NYU Shanghai
CSCI-SHU 360 Machine Learning
CSCI-SHU 220 Algorithms |
| Fall 2025 | • Learning Assistant, NYU Shanghai
CSCI-SHU 360 Machine Learning
CSCI-SHU 210 Data Structures |

AWARDS

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|------|--|
| 2026 | • NYU Doctoral Fellowship, New York University
• Summa Cum Laude (top 5%), NYU Shanghai
• Major Honors in Computer Science, NYU Shanghai |
| 2024 | • BaoSteel Scholarship, NYU Shanghai |
| 2022 | • Lizhong Scholarship (full scholarship), NYU Shanghai |

SERVICE

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| Reviewer | • ICML 2026 Workshop on EMM-QA |
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